

**KICKSTARTER**

For creators

Log in

 Search projects, creators, and categories

s Crafts Dance Design Fashion Film Food Games Journalism Music Photography Publishing Technology Theater

## Hermes - Eudora's Next Generation



Resurrect the popular Eudora eMail client as an open-source project compatible with modern security - re-named Hermes (legal reasons)

Created by

Nicholas Edward Werner-Matavka

**78 backers** pledged CA\$ 3,373 to help bring this project to life.

 **Last updated** March 29, 2020

[Campaign](#)[Rewards](#)[Creator](#)[FAQ](#)[Updates](#) <sup>14</sup>[Comments](#) <sup>69</sup>[Community](#)[📍 Toronto, Canada](#) [🔧 Software](#)**CA\$ 3,373**

pledged of CA\$ 500 goal

**78**

backers

## Funding period

Sep 6 2018 - Nov 5 2018 (60 days)

## Story

In 1988, Steve Dorner wrote an eMail client that soon grew to have an army of very satisfied users. It was named "Eudora" in honour of American authoress Eudora Welty, who wrote a short story called "Why I Live at the P.O." Eudora quickly gained a legion of fans and was bought out by Qualcomm in 1991. Fast forward to 2006 and, amidst shifting corporate priorities, Qualcomm Eudora was killed off, to be replaced by a pale imitation called Eudora OSE. This was not well received and soon died as well.

Eudora still has its fans, though, which is why we're bringing it back! This year, its code was open-sourced and given to the Computer History Museum. Seeing that nobody has taken on the monumental task of reviving this excellent piece of software and updating it to comply with today's standards, I picked up development myself, along with a talented team of C++ programmers.

Legal encumbrances prevented us from using the Eudora name, so the program has been re-christened Hermes, after the Greek personification of business and patron deity of messengers. Make no mistake, though, it's still the same Eudora you know and love. It's the "real McCoy"---no imitation and certainly no OSE.

## Features

- Play your music for new mail and filters
- Recent Mail
- Saved Search
- Criteria
- Add a picture or logo to your signature

- Updated SpamWatch definitions
- Ultra-Fast Indexed Search
- Secure MIME plug-in
- SpamWatch
- ScamWatch
- OpenSSL
- Improved IMAP Emoticons
- WebWords
- Content Concentrator
- Contextual Filing advanced matching
- Improved Outlook importer
- IMAP mailbox synch
- Format Painter
- New toolbar icons
- Fast, powerful search
- Enhanced filters
- Virus protection
- Drag and drop attachments
- Formatting and styles
- Strikeout style button
- In-line spell checking
- Colour labelling
- Customisable toolbar
- Mail sort
- Kerberos V authentication
- Eudora Sharing Protocol
- Powerful address book
- MoodWatch
- eMail usage stats
- Multi-tasking
- Automatic name and address completion
- Task progress window
- Personalities
- IMAP
- Secure Sockets Layer

## Risks and challenges

The main challenge with compiling and delivering Hermes is that, as written by Qualcomm, it depends on a customised user interface toolkit known as RogueWave Stingray and will not compile without it. This is commercial software and could not be distributed with the source code; that said, native UI toolkits are now much more powerful than they were in 2005, and RogueWave can therefore be replaced with WxWidgets. There *\*will\** be a version for Mac and another version for Linux. We plan to support all major computing platforms.

As originally written, Hermes (then known as Eudora) used Microsoft Trident for its HTML eMail viewer/editor. This is the same engine as displays Web pages in Internet Explorer, a software package that is now deprecated. It will have to be replaced, most probably with Gecko (its Firefox equivalent). Spell check will also have to be replaced, as will the unsolicited mail ("junk") filter (preferably with a Bayesian alternative, e.g. SpamAssassin or Bogofilter).

That said, we have a talented team of developers that should be able to get this project off the ground and delivered Real Soon Now! Look out for the QCSSL dll required for Eudora to communicate with modern SSL servers!

[Learn about accountability on Kickstarter](#)

Questions about this project? [Check out the FAQ](#)

---

[Report this project to Kickstarter](#)

Similar projects to check out

[See more](#)



 Save our oceans. Take Wildtype mainstream. 

Justin Kolbeck



 Zen Tea Brew Infusions: Discover Delicious Rare Shizuoka Tea 

Zen Tea Brew



 Faire in the Field: Year Two! 

Patrick Munroe-Smith

 2 days left • 104% funded



 **Laughing Gull Chocolates Take Flight**

Lindsay



 10 days left • 81% funded



Discover

Arts

Comics & Illustration

Design & Tech

Film

Food & Craft

Games

Music

Publishing

About

About us

Our charter

Press

Jobs

Support

Help Center

Our Rules

Creator Resources

Forward Funds

Brand assets

More

Newsletters

Kickstarter Project Updates

The Creative Independent

Mobile apps

Research

KICKSTARTER

English

\$ US Dollar (USD)



Download on the  
App Store



GET IT ON  
Google Play

Kickstarter, PBC © 2026

[Trust & Safety](#) [Terms of Use](#) [Privacy Policy](#) [Cookie Policy](#) [Cookie Preferences](#) [Accessibility Statement](#) [CA Notice of Consent](#)

